

FACE RECOGNITION ATTENDANCE SYSTEM

PYTHON PROJECT FILE

**BACHELOR OF TECHNOLOGY
IN
COMPUTER SCIENCE AND ENGINEERING**

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ABSTRACT

This project presents the design and development of an “**Image Recognition Attendance System**”, an intelligent and automated solution aimed at improving the efficiency and accuracy of traditional attendance methods. Conventional attendance systems are often manual, time-consuming, and susceptible to errors such as proxy attendance and incorrect record management. This project addresses these limitations by leveraging modern **computer vision and data processing techniques**.

The system is implemented using **Python** and integrates powerful libraries such as **OpenCV** for real-time face detection and recognition, **NumPy** for efficient numerical operations, and **Pandas** for structured data storage and management. The application captures live video input through a webcam, detects human faces, and compares them with a pre-existing dataset of registered individuals. Upon successful identification, the system automatically marks attendance and stores it in a well-organized format such as a **CSV file**.

A key feature of this system is its ability to operate in real time, ensuring **fast and reliable** attendance marking without human intervention. Additionally, the use of data handling tools ensures that attendance records are easily accessible, modifiable, and scalable for future use.

This project demonstrates the practical implementation of **Artificial Intelligence, Machine Learning concepts, and image processing techniques** in solving real-world problems. The developed system significantly reduces manual effort, enhances accuracy, and ensures transparency in attendance tracking. Furthermore, the system is designed with scalability and adaptability in mind, allowing it to be extended for use in larger environments such as educational institutions, offices, and organizations. Future enhancements can include integration with cloud-based databases, mobile applications, and advanced deep learning models to further improve recognition accuracy and system performance.

Overall, **the Image Recognition Attendance System** highlights the potential of intelligent automation in transforming traditional processes into efficient, secure, and user-friendly solutions.

PROBLEM STATEMENT

The Inefficiency of Traditional Attendance Systems:

The process of recording attendance in educational institutions and organizations is still largely manual and time-consuming. Conventional methods such as paper registers or simple digital entry systems are prone to human errors, manipulation, and inefficiency. In many cases, proxy attendance (marking attendance on behalf of others) compromises the authenticity of records. As the number of students or employees increases, managing and maintaining accurate attendance data becomes increasingly difficult and unreliable.

Limitations of Manual and Semi-Automated Systems:

Existing attendance systems suffer from several critical limitations. Manual entry requires continuous supervision and consumes valuable time during lectures or working hours. Even semi-automated systems such as ID card scanning or biometric devices involve physical interaction, which can lead to delays, hardware dependency, and maintenance issues.

Currently, institutions face the following challenges:

Time Consumption Manual attendance recording reduces effective working or teaching time.

Proxy Attendance: Lack of strict identity verification allows unauthorized attendance marking.

Data Management Issues: Maintaining and analyzing large attendance records is difficult without proper automation.

The Need for an Intelligent Automated Solution:

To overcome these challenges, there is a need for a smart attendance system that integrates computer vision and data processing techniques. Such a system should be capable of automatically detecting and recognizing individuals, marking attendance in real time, and storing records in a structured and accessible format.

This project addresses these issues by developing an Image Recognition Attendance System that minimizes human intervention, enhances accuracy, and ensures secure and efficient attendance management.

SOFTWARE REQUIREMENT SPECIFICATION

The **Software Requirement Specification (SRS)** provides a detailed description of the functional and non-functional requirements of the Image Recognition Attendance System. It defines the system behavior, required resources, and operational constraints necessary for successful implementation.

Functional Requirements:

Functional requirements describe the core operations that the system must perform:

- **User Input Module:** The system shall capture real-time video input through a webcam.
- **Face Detection:** The system shall detect human faces using OpenCV algorithms.
- **Face Recognition:** The system shall compare detected faces with a pre-stored dataset to identify individuals.
- **Attendance Marking:** The system shall automatically mark attendance upon successful recognition.
- **Data Storage:** The system shall store attendance records in a structured format such as a CSV file using Pandas.
- **Duplicate Prevention:** The system shall ensure that attendance for an individual is recorded only once per session.

Non-Functional Requirements:

Non-functional requirements define the quality attributes and performance expectations:

Performance: The system should process input and mark attendance in real time with minimal delay.

Accuracy: The system should provide high accuracy in face detection and recognition.

- ***Usability:*** The system interface should be simple and easy to use.
- ***Reliability:*** The system should function consistently without crashes or data loss.
- ***Scalability:*** The system should be capable of handling larger datasets in future expansions.

METHODOLOGY AND IMPLEMENTATION

System Overview:

The Image Recognition Attendance System is designed to automate the attendance process using computer vision techniques. The system captures real-time video input, detects faces, recognizes individuals, and records attendance in a structured format. The methodology follows a step-by-step pipeline to ensure accuracy, efficiency, and reliability.

Data Collection and Preparation:

The first step involves collecting images of registered individuals. These images are stored in a dataset and labeled accordingly. Proper data preparation ensures that the system can accurately recognize faces during execution.

- Images are stored in a structured folder format
- Each image corresponds to a unique individual
- Preprocessing is applied to standardize image size and format

Face Detection:

Face detection is performed using OpenCV, which identifies human faces in real-time video frames captured through a webcam.

- *Haar Cascade classifiers are used for detecting faces*
- *The system scans each frame to locate facial regions*
- *Detected faces are extracted for further processing*

Face Recognition:

Once faces are detected, the system compares them with the stored dataset to identify individuals.

- Facial features are encoded into numerical representations
- The system matches these features with known data
- If a match is found, the identity of the person is confirmed

Attendance Marking:

After successful recognition, the system automatically marks attendance.

- Each recognized individual is marked present
- Duplicate entries are avoided within the same session
- Time and date of attendance are recorded

Data Storage and Management:

Attendance data is managed using Pandas, which ensures efficient storage and retrieval.

- Records are stored in CSV format
- Data is structured for easy analysis and future use
- The system allows scalability for larger datasets

System Execution

- Flow: Start the system
- Capture video input from webcam
- Detect faces in each frame
- Recognize detected faces
- Mark attendance if match found
- Store attendance data
- Repeat until system is stopped

TECHNICAL IMPLEMENTATION

System Architecture Overview:

The Image Recognition Attendance System is built using a modular architecture that integrates computer vision, data processing, and storage components. The system processes real-time video input, performs face detection and recognition, and updates attendance records dynamically.

Programming Language – Python:

Python serves as the core programming language for the system due to its simplicity, flexibility, and strong support for machine learning and computer vision libraries.

- *Provides easy integration with OpenCV, NumPy, and Pandas*
- *Supports rapid development and prototyping*
- *Efficient handling of image data and file operations*

Face Detection using OpenCV:

The system uses **OpenCV (Open Source Computer Vision Library)** for detecting faces in real-time video streams.

- Haar Cascade Classifier is used for object detection
- Converts frames into grayscale for faster processing
- Detects facial regions based on pre-trained features
- Bounding boxes are drawn around detected faces

This ensures fast and reliable detection even in live video conditions.

Face Recognition Mechanism:

After detecting faces, the system performs recognition by comparing facial features with stored images.

- Images are converted into numerical arrays using NumPy
- Feature extraction is performed to capture unique facial patterns
- Matching is done by comparing current frame data with stored dataset
- Threshold-based comparison determines identity

This approach ensures accurate identification of individuals.

Data Processing using NumPy:

NumPy plays a crucial role in handling image data efficiently.

- *Images are represented as multi-dimensional arrays*
- *Enables fast mathematical operations on pixel values*
- *Optimizes performance during face comparison*

Attendance Management using Pandas:

The system uses Pandas for managing attendance records in a structured format.

- *Data is stored in CSV files*
- *Each entry includes name, date, and time*
- *Duplicate entries are avoided using data filtering*
- *Enables easy data analysis and modification*

Real-Time System Execution:

The system operates in real time by continuously capturing frames from the webcam.

- Each frame is processed instantly
- Face detection and recognition occur simultaneously
- Attendance is updated dynamically without delays

Integration and Workflow:

All components are integrated to form a seamless pipeline:

1. Webcam captures live video
2. OpenCV detects faces
3. NumPy processes image data
4. Recognition algorithm identifies individuals
5. Pandas records attendance

Performance Considerations:

- *Optimized for real-time execution*
- *Lightweight and efficient for standard systems*
- *Handles moderate datasets effectively*
- *Designed for future scalability with advanced models*

The technical implementation of this system demonstrates the effective integration of computer vision, data processing, and automation techniques, resulting in a robust and efficient attendance management solution.

SOURCE CODE

on_cv_project > main.py > ...

```
import argparse
import csv
from datetime import datetime
from pathlib import Path
import time

import cv2
import numpy as np

BASE_DIR = Path(__file__).resolve().parent
FACES_DIR = BASE_DIR / 'faces'
MODEL_FILE = BASE_DIR / 'face_recognizer.yml'
ATTENDANCE_FILE = BASE_DIR / 'attendance.csv'
IMAGE_SIZE = (200, 200)
IMAGE_EXTENSIONS = {'.jpg', '.jpeg', '.png', '.bmp', '.pgm'}
DEFAULT_THRESHOLD = 70.0
SAMPLE_DELAY = 0.5
FIELDNAMES = ['date', 'time', 'name']

def ensure_dirs():
    FACES_DIR.mkdir(parents=True, exist_ok=True)
    ATTENDANCE_FILE.parent.mkdir(parents=True, exist_ok=True)

def load_face_cascade():
    cascade = cv2.CascadeClassifier(
        cv2.data.haarcascades + 'haarcascade_frontalface_default.xml'
    )
    if cascade.empty():
        raise RuntimeError('Could not load Haar cascade classifier.')
    return cascade

def detect_largest_face(gray_frame, face_cascade):
    faces = face_cascade.detectMultiScale(
        gray_frame,
        scaleFactor=1.1,
        minNeighbors=5,
        minSize=(80, 80),
        flags=cv2.CASCADE_SCALE_IMAGE,
    )
    if len(faces) == 0:
        return None
    return max(faces, key=lambda rect: rect[2] * rect[3])

def crop_face(frame, face_rect):
    x, y, w, h = face_rect
    face = frame[y : y + h, x : x + w]
    return cv2.resize(face, IMAGE_SIZE, interpolation=cv2.INTER_AREA)

def draw_label(frame, text, x, y):
    font = cv2.FONT_HERSHEY_SIMPLEX
    text_size, _ = cv2.getTextSize(text, font, 0.6, 1)
    cv2.rectangle(
        frame,
        (x, y - text_size[1] - 14),
        (x + text_size[0] + 10, y + 5),
        (0, 0, 0),
        cv2.FILLED,
    )
    cv2.putText(frame, text, (x + 5, y - 5), font, 0.6, (255, 255, 255), 1)

def get_image_paths(person_dir):
    return sorted(
        [
            path
            for path in person_dir.iterdir()
            if path.is_file() and path.suffix.lower() in IMAGE_EXTENSIONS
        ]
    )

def list_registered_faces():
    return sorted([folder.name for folder in FACES_DIR.iterdir() if folder.is_dir()])

def get_label_map():
    return {idx: name for idx, name in enumerate(list_registered_faces())}

def train_recognizer():
    faces = []
    labels = []
    label_map = {}
    current_label = 0

    for person_dir in sorted(FACES_DIR.iterdir()):
        if not person_dir.is_dir():
            continue
        image_files = get_image_paths(person_dir)
        if not image_files:
            continue
```

```

def train_recognizer():
    for person_dir in sorted(FACES_DIR.iterdir()):
        if not person_dir.is_dir():
            continue
        image_files = get_image_paths(person_dir)
        if not image_files:
            continue

        label_map[current_label] = person_dir.name
        for image_path in image_files:
            image = cv2.imread(str(image_path), cv2.IMREAD_GRAYSCALE)
            if image is None:
                continue
            faces.append(cv2.resize(image, IMAGE_SIZE, interpolation=cv2.INTER_LINEAR))
            labels.append(current_label)
        current_label += 1

    if not faces:
        return None, {}

    faces = [np.asarray(face, dtype=np.uint8) for face in faces]
    labels = np.asarray(labels, dtype=np.int32)

    recognizer = cv2.face.LBPHFaceRecognizer_create()
    recognizer.train(faces, labels)
    recognizer.write(str(MODEL_FILE))
    return recognizer, label_map

def load_recognizer():
    if not MODEL_FILE.exists():
        return None, {}

    recognizer = cv2.face.LBPHFaceRecognizer_create()
    recognizer.read(str(MODEL_FILE))
    return recognizer, get_label_map()

def get_today_attendance():
    attendance = set()
    today = datetime.now().date().isoformat()
    if not ATTENDANCE_FILE.exists():
        return attendance
    with ATTENDANCE_FILE.open(newline='') as csvfile:
        reader = csv.DictReader(csvfile)
        for row in reader:
            if row.get('date') == today and row.get('name'):
                attendance.add(row['name'])
    return attendance

def list_attendance(date=None):
    entries = []
    if not ATTENDANCE_FILE.exists():
        return entries
    with ATTENDANCE_FILE.open(newline='') as csvfile:
        reader = csv.DictReader(csvfile)
        for row in reader:
            if date is None or row.get('date') == date:
                entries.append(row)
    return entries

def append_attendance(name):
    first_write = not ATTENDANCE_FILE.exists()
    with ATTENDANCE_FILE.open('a', newline='') as csvfile:
        writer = csv.DictWriter(csvfile, fieldnames=FIELDNAMES)
        if first_write:
            writer.writeheader()
        now = datetime.now()
        writer.writerow({
            'date': now.date().isoformat(),
            'time': now.strftime('%H:%M:%S'),
            'name': name,
        })

def clear_attendance(date=None):
    if not ATTENDANCE_FILE.exists():
        return False

    if date is None:
        date = datetime.now().date().isoformat()

    rows = []
    with ATTENDANCE_FILE.open(newline='') as csvfile:
        reader = csv.DictReader(csvfile)
        for row in reader:
            if row.get('date') != date:
                rows.append(row)

    with ATTENDANCE_FILE.open('w', newline='') as csvfile:
        writer = csv.DictWriter(csvfile, fieldnames=FIELDNAMES)
        writer.writeheader()
        writer.writerows(rows)

    return True

```

```

def register_face(name, camera_index, sample_count, face_cascade):
    person_dir = FACES_DIR / name
    person_dir.mkdir(parents=True, exist_ok=True)
    cap = cv2.VideoCapture(camera_index)
    if not cap.isOpened():
        raise RuntimeError(f'Cannot open camera index {camera_index}')

    print(f'Registering face for "{name}". Press ESC to cancel.')
    saved = 0
    last_saved = 0

    while saved < sample_count:
        ret, frame = cap.read()
        if not ret:
            print('Unable to read from camera.')
            break

        gray = cv2.cvtColor(frame, cv2.COLOR_BGR2GRAY)
        face_rect = detect_largest_face(gray, face_cascade)

        if face_rect is not None:
            x, y, w, h = face_rect
            face = crop_face(gray, face_rect)
            elapsed = time.time() - last_saved
            if elapsed >= SAMPLE_DELAY:
                filename = person_dir / f'{name}_{saved + 1}.png'
                cv2.imwrite(str(filename), face)
                saved += 1
                last_saved = time.time()

            cv2.rectangle(frame, (x, y), (x + w, y + h), (0, 255, 0), 2)
            draw_label(frame, f'Saving {saved}/{sample_count}', x, y)
        else:
            cv2.putText(
                frame,
                'Show your face clearly to the camera',
                (10, 30),
                cv2.FONT_HERSHEY_SIMPLEX,
                0.7,
                (0, 255, 255),
                2,
                cv2.LINE_AA,
            )

        cv2.imshow('Register Face', frame)
        key = cv2.waitKey(1) & 0xFF
        if key == 27:
            break

    register_face(name, camera_index, sample_count, face_cascade).
    cv2.destroyAllWindows()

    if saved >= sample_count:
        print(f'Registered {saved} samples for {name}. Training recognizer...')
        train_recognizer()
        print('Training complete.')
    else:
        print('Registration incomplete. Try again.')

attendance_loop(camera_index, face_cascade, recognizer, label_map, threshold)
cap = cv2.VideoCapture(camera_index)
if not cap.isOpened():
    raise RuntimeError(f'Cannot open camera index {camera_index}')

attendance = get_today_attendance()
print('Attendance mode running. Press ESC to quit.')

while True:
    ret, frame = cap.read()
    if not ret:
        print('Unable to read from camera.')
        break

    gray = cv2.cvtColor(frame, cv2.COLOR_BGR2GRAY)
    face_rect = detect_largest_face(gray, face_cascade)
    display_text = 'No face detected'

    if face_rect is not None:
        x, y, w, h = face_rect
        face = crop_face(gray, face_rect)
        label, confidence = recognizer.predict(face)
        name = label_map.get(label, 'Unknown')
        if confidence > threshold:
            name = 'Unknown'
        else:
            if name not in attendance:
                append_attendance(name)
                attendance.add(name)
                print(f'Attendance marked: {name}')
            display_text = f'{name} ({confidence:.0f})'

        cv2.rectangle(frame, (x, y), (x + w, y + h), (0, 255, 0), 2)
        draw_label(frame, display_text, x, y)
    else:
        cv2.putText(
            frame,
            display_text,
            (10, 30),
            cv2.FONT_HERSHEY_SIMPLEX,
            0.7,
            (0, 255, 255),
            2,
            cv2.LINE_AA,
        )

        cv2.imshow('Attendance Mode', frame)
        key = cv2.waitKey(1) & 0xFF
        if key == 27:
            break

```

```

detect_only(camera_index, face_cascade):
    if not cap.isOpened():
        raise RuntimeError(f'Cannot open camera index {camera_index}')
    print('Face detection mode. Press ESC to quit.')

    while True:
        ret, frame = cap.read()
        if not ret:
            print('Unable to read from camera.')
            break

        gray = cv2.cvtColor(frame, cv2.COLOR_BGR2GRAY)
        face_rect = detect_largest_face(gray, face_cascade)
        if face_rect is not None:
            x, y, w, h = face_rect
            cv2.rectangle(frame, (x, y), (x + w, y + h), (0, 255, 0), 2)
            cv2.putText(
                frame,
                'Face detected',
                (x, y - 10),
                cv2.FONT_HERSHEY_SIMPLEX,
                0.8,
                (0, 255, 0),
                2,
                cv2.LINE_AA,
            )

            cv2.imshow('Detect', frame)
            key = cv2.waitKey(1) & 0xFF
            if key == 27:
                break

    cap.release()
    cv2.destroyAllWindows()

def main():
    parser = argparse.ArgumentParser(description='Python OpenCV attendance system.')
    parser.add_argument(
        '--mode',
        choices=['attendance', 'register', 'detect', 'list', 'clear'],
        default='attendance',
        help='Mode to run',
    )
    parser.add_argument('--name', type=str, help='Name to register (register mode only)')
    parser.add_argument('--camera', type=int, default=0, help='Camera device index')
    parser.add_argument('--samples', type=int, default=20, help='Number of face samples to capture')
    parser.add_argument('--threshold', type=float, default=DEFAULT_THRESHOLD, help='Recognition threshold')
    parser.add_argument('--date', type=str, help='Date for list/clear modes in YYYY-MM-DD format')
    parser.add_argument('--show-all', action='store_true', help='Show all attendance records when listing')
    args = parser.parse_args()

    # Load face cascade
    load_face_cascade()

    # Register mode
    if args.mode == 'register':
        s.name = args.name
        if not s.name:
            error('--name is required when --mode register')
        ace(args.name.strip().replace(' ', '_'), args.camera, args.samples, face_cascade)

    # List mode
    if args.mode == 'list':
        if args.show_all:
            list_attendance(args.date)
        else:
            list_attendance(args.date)
        if not entries:
            print('No attendance records found.')

    # Clear mode
    if args.mode == 'clear':
        clear_date = args.date
        if not clear_date:
            clear_date = datetime.now().date().isoformat()
        clear_attendance(clear_date)
        if not entries:
            print('Attendance records cleared for {clear_date or datetime.now().date().isoformat().}')

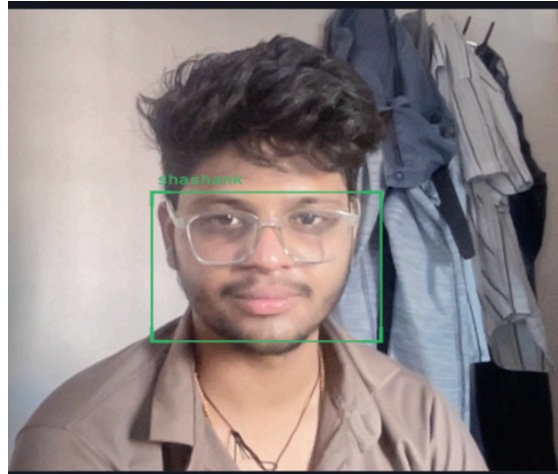
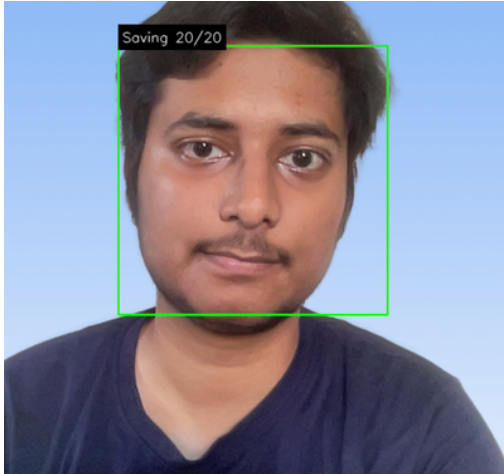
    # Detect mode
    if args.mode == 'detect':
        detect_only(args.camera, face_cascade)

    # Train mode
    if args.mode == 'train':
        bel_map = load_recognizer()
        if not bel_map or not label_map:
            bel_map, label_map = train_recognizer()
        if not bel_map or not label_map:
            error('No registered faces found. Run with --mode register --name NAME first.')

    # Main loop
    while True:
        p(args.camera, face_cascade, recognizer, label_map, args.threshold)

```


SCREENSHOTS



```
.venv) ashishranjan@Ashishs-MacBook-Air smite-attendance-main % cd python_cv_project
.venv) ashishranjan@Ashishs-MacBook-Air python_cv_project % python main.py --mode register --name "Mohit " --samples 20
registering face for "Mohit". Press ESC to cancel.
registered 20 samples for Mohit. Training recognizer...
training complete.
.venv) ashishranjan@Ashishs-MacBook-Air python_cv_project % python main.py --mode attendance

attendance mode running. Press ESC to quit.
attendance marked: Mohit
.venv) ashishranjan@Ashishs-MacBook-Air python_cv_project % python main.py --mode register --name "Shashank Upadhyia" --samples 20
registering face for "Shashank Upadhyia". Press ESC to cancel.
registered 20 samples for Shashank Upadhyia. Training recognizer...
training complete.
.venv) ashishranjan@Ashishs-MacBook-Air python_cv_project % python main.py --mode attendance

attendance mode running. Press ESC to quit.
attendance marked: Shashank Upadhyia
.venv) ashishranjan@Ashishs-MacBook-Air python_cv_project % python main.py --mode attendance

attendance mode running. Press ESC to quit.
attendance marked: Ashish_Mishra
.venv) ashishranjan@Ashishs-MacBook-Air python_cv_project % python main.py --mode list --show-all
attendance records:
026-04-16 14:26:51 - John_Doe
026-04-27 15:52:15 - John_Doe
026-04-27 15:52:16 - TestUser
026-04-27 15:55:19 - Ashish_Ranjan
026-04-27 16:22:40 - Mohit
026-04-27 16:24:25 - Shashank Upadhyia
026-04-27 16:24:43 - Ashish_Mishra
.venv) ashishranjan@Ashishs-MacBook-Air python_cv_project %
```


RESULT AND TESTING

System Output Overview:

The Image Recognition Attendance System was successfully implemented and tested under various conditions to evaluate its performance, accuracy, and reliability. The system demonstrated the ability to detect and recognize faces in real time and automatically mark attendance without manual intervention.

Test Case Analysis:

Scenario 1: Known Face Detection

- *Input: Registered individual in front of webcam*
- *Observation: Face detected and correctly recognized*
- *Result: Attendance marked successfully with correct name, date, and time*

Scenario 3: Multiple Face Detection

- *Input: More than one individual in frame*
- *Observation: System detected multiple faces simultaneously*
- *Result: Attendance marked only for recognized individuals*

Scenario 4: Lighting Variation

- *Input: Different lighting conditions (bright/dim)*
- *Observation: Slight variation in detection accuracy*
- *Result: System performs well in normal lighting but may require optimization in low light*

CONCLUSION AND FUTURE SCOPE

Conclusion:

The Image Recognition Attendance System successfully demonstrates the application of computer vision and data processing techniques in automating the traditional attendance process. The system effectively detects and recognizes faces in real time, marks attendance accurately, and stores records in a structured format without manual intervention.

By integrating technologies such as **Python, OpenCV, NumPy, and Pandas**, the project achieves high efficiency, reliability, and usability. It eliminates common issues associated with manual attendance systems, including time consumption, human errors, and proxy attendance. The system ensures transparency and accuracy, making it a practical solution for educational institutions and organizations.

Overall, this project highlights how **Artificial Intelligence and automation** can be leveraged to simplify routine tasks and improve productivity in real-world applications.

Future Scope:

Although the current system performs effectively, several enhancements can be implemented to further improve its functionality and scalability:

- ***Deep Learning Integration:*** Use advanced models such as CNNs for more accurate and robust face recognition.
- ***Cloud Database Integration:*** Store attendance data on cloud platforms for better accessibility and scalability.
- ***Mobile Application Support:*** Develop a mobile-based interface for easier access and monitoring.
- ***Improved Accuracy in Challenging Conditions:*** Enhance performance under low light, occlusions, and different angles.
- ***Multi-User and Multi-Camera Support:*** Extend the system for large-scale environments such as universities or organizations.

With these improvements, the system can evolve into a more powerful, scalable, and industry-ready solution for automated attendance management.